Silverheights School Council Meeting Minutes

Date & Time: Oct 22, 2025 - 6:30 to 8:00 - library

Hybrid Meeting - https://meet.google.com/chx-bcyt-pvr

School Council Meeting

> *"Parents play a vital role in the development and education of their children and in the success of schools. They are the most important influence in a child's life outside of school.*
> *Long after direct learning from parents in a child's early years gives way to formal education, parents continue to play a key role in student success through the attitudes they help to share and the direct supports they provide."*
>
> Ontario Ministry of Education

School Council Summary: https://www.wrdsb.ca/our-schools/get-involved/school-councils/

School Council Handbook: https://www.wrdsb.ca/wp-content/uploads/school_council_chairpersons_handbook.pdf

A school council is an advisory body that functions within the parameters of Ministry of Education and Board policy. School councils provide an opportunity and the means to advise the principal and the Board on any matter pertaining to improvement of pupil achievement and enhancing the accountability of the education system to parents/guardians. The ultimate responsibility for the administration and management of the day-to-day operation of the school rests with the principal.

Item	Agenda Item	Duration	Person(s) Responsible
1	**Welcome** Present: Andrea Schofield, Heather Train, Darpana Sanghvi, Jason Stere, Alison Chong, Caroline Rainville, Shaun McCracken, Ling Tam, Tara Goudy, Michelle Thompson, Alissa Fraser, Amy Lucas Online: Jenna Northover, Lindsay Paetkau Regrets: Leah McCreight, Sandra Broocks, Alison McGauley, Elise Gammie, Kristen Medencevic, Kristen Yinger, Ariel Buchan, Erin Ambachstheer, Ruby Hansmann, Ramya Venugopal, Emily Cooper, Navdeep Kaur, Sunny Sharma, Tammy Nguyen, Supriya Anand, Amanda Elliott, Christina Galway, Sara Khlat, Kate Davy	1 mins	Co-Chair
2	**Territorial Acknowledgement & Equity Connection** - School wide Blue Jays swag raffle for spirit building	2 mins	Vice Principal (T. Goudy)
3	**Council Housekeeping** - Approval of Sept School Council Minutes	5 mins	Co-Chair (L.Tam)
4	**News**		
	Community Partnership – Silverheights Neighbourhood Association - **Update** www.silverheightsneighnourhood.com - For more information, please email programs@silverheightsneighbourhood.com - Fall program registration open & drop-in programs underway. - PD Camp registration open. - Evening programs running with spaces like cooking club, science, arts and crafts once a week, drop in open gym Tues/Wed/Thur ages 5-12 - Girls Leadership ages 10-14 - Powerpass available online	5 mins	SNA Representative

	- Curiosity surrounding a bicycle program for refurbishing and recycling perhaps for the community, potential to also discuss bike bus, bike safety, helmet give away, - programs@silverheightsneighbourhood.com		
	WRAPC/PIC https://www.wrdsb.ca/our-schools/get-involved/wrapsc/ - WRAPSC Minutes Website offers monthly Webinars 'Lunch and Learn' todays was Screen time with your teen Next month there is a guest speaker Dr. Allison Yeung Youth related event- explore your future Tuesday Nov 4th, opportunity to network with local employers for volunteering, coop positions	5 mins	WRAPSC Rep (vacant)
	Teacher Update ● Last month the Terry Fox run was very successful ● Clubs have started up, Gr 5 games club, Intermediate D&D, Volleyball tryouts ● Fall food drive went well ● Umbrella theme: Empathy ● Track and field- spring time covered through Phys Ed, currently no cross country	10 mins	Teacher Rep (A. Schofield)
5	**Principal's Report** ● Progress reports underway; these interim reports are different from formal report card gradings. ● "Be Kind" initiative with the educators & admin team underway to address behaviours in classroom and among students. Educators are identifying a lack of understanding & definition of "bullying", micro-aggressions, vs disrespectful behaviour. Staff are being challenged to define, "what does kindness mean to the students?" ○ Emotional toolkit - students contribute to a classroom "kit" that could include fidgets, comfort textures, mindfulness/calming materials, connection tools etc. ○ ● Educators are requesting ideas from parents to engage in this initiative for next Council meeting. Silverheights PS may request support from Council in the form of financial or other supports, to be discussed at next Council meeting. ● Potential for strike action by part-time staff at the daycare and Youth Development Program (YDP) run by Conestoga College in the Silverheights building (southeast portion of building). Communications from union and Conestoga College will be shared via School Day. The daycare and YDP will close if work action occurs & any worker protest to be limited to public area (sidewalk) and not on school property.	10 mins	Principal (J. Stere)
6	**New Agenda Items- Funding Proposals:** - Caregivers Workshop - Supporting Kids with ASD - Connecting with Community supports - Request for ~$500 for running workshop for select Silverheights families identified by SERT team. - Supplemental information package of resources may be made available to the greater school community pending approval by School Admin. - SERT team thinking to offer this workshop to select families by invitation only (~14 families). Question	10 mins	- A. Schofield - T. Goudy

from parent about equity & accessibility of these resources by families that may not yet received formal diagnosis or only just starting to look into resources.
        - Looking for financial support for food/bev for attendees & support (honorarium) for babysitting. Estimated financial support of $500 (based on total # of attendees)
        - Supplemental information package may be made available to the school community.
- Supporting Students with Self-Regulation
    - Request for $925 for replacement and additional items in the Snoezelen (relaxation) and Sensory Diet rooms.
    - Items include: noise cancelling headphones, spinny chairs, rotating pod chairs, braces for fish tubes, Needo Nice cubes, figure optic lights.
        - Self-regulation spaces at Silverheights: Snoezelen Rooms (relaxation) & Sensory Diet room (reset nervous system). Request for additional items: noise cancelling headphones, spinny chair, egg chair, fish tube brace, Needo Nice Cube, Fiber Optic Light
        - Estimated financial support ~$925
- Proposal from Donna King - Google Slides
    - Request for ~$1000 for materials to support health & safety within the building (beyond standard equipment supplied by WRDSB)
    - Items includes: 12 garbage pickers $106, 10 reusable mop systems ($361.51), ground sweeper (to remove sand/gravel from tarmac, $500)
        - Request for 10 more fibre mops = $350
        - Garbage Grabber/Pickers (12 units) = $110 Suggest contacting City of Cambridge Environmental Services for supplies.
        - Ground Sweeper to keep sand & gravel off the tarmac (major source of injury) = $350
        - Estimated = $860
- October 2025 Requests for School Council Funds
    - Library request for Cricut and consumable materials. Additional detail (cost, rationale, connection to curriculum) needed. Council to defer approval until November. deferred for additional detail.
    - Student Club request to support Umbrella Project, Bracelets for Kindness month: Request for $300 to purchase materials and accessible beads to create bracelets for each student in the school.
    - Junior staff request for microphones: Council to defer approval until November pending additional details (battery or rechargeable)
        - What is the funding value of this proposal?
    - Removed from Council approval: Mod Podge / White Gesso to be reviewed from school budget.
- Pro Grant / PIC Grant
    - Applicable to Umbrella Project & “Be Kind” initiatives
    - Parent volunteer to research potential books related to empathy and kindness skills for the next parent book club.
    - Additional ideas: Bike rodeo, bike bus. These initiatives to be discussed as a separate subcommittee to be presented at next Council meeting.

	- Several parent volunteers needed to contact and coordinate with community resources (Student Transportation, WRPS, community non-profit charities, SNA partnership)		
7	**Financial Report** - Recognition to Pizza Subcommittee members to get an early start to Pizza Days has increased the number of days this school year. - Total of 35 weeks of Pizza Days from Sept through June - Projected 89-91 pizzas per week to bring in approximately $70,000 - $35,000 payment to vendor (Dominos) - Review of staple expenses from previous years: o School Day transaction fees 2% o Spirit wear = ~$450 o Grade 8 Celebration = ~$5000 o Field Trip Support = $4500 (allocation of $200 per classroom for teachers to use towards transportation or admission. There are 29 homerooms) o Breaking Barrier Equity Access Funds = $1000 (administered by Silverheights Admin to families requesting support to access field trips, spirit wear, etc.) o E-way Credit = $4000 ($100 per educator within Silverheights) - Council to merge the Spirit Wear budget with Breaking Barrier Equity Access Fund for budget line item of $1000. - Council to defer approval of E-way credit until January 2026 pending evaluation of revenue from Pizza Day sales - Motion to approve remaining items passed.	10 min	Treasurer (S. McCracken)
8	**Subcommittees** **1) Pizza Subcommittee - Chair - K. Davey** o Members: ▪ Chair - Kate Davy ▪ Secretary - Heather Train ▪ Volunteer Coordinator - Shaun McCracken ▪ Pizza Procurement Specialist - Darpana Sanghvi o Update o New ownership and management delivering well and on time o Smooth pizza days with minor hiccups being solved o Pizza day class volunteers grades 5 and up o Give a slice program being utilized and the rest of needed slices being subsidized by School Council **2) Activity Fair Subcommittee** o List of community camp offerings being generated by Caroline Rainville. Parents encouraged to provide community contacts or organization to add to the list. o File to be emailed to Council & Admin for review prior to sharing online via School Day.	15 mins	Chair (A. Jones)
9	**Questions & Answer Period**	5 mins	Council Members
10	**Next Meeting Date:** Nov 26, 2025 6:30 to 8:30 in library		In-person
11	**Agenda Items for Next Meeting**	1 min	Chair

	The mission of the School Council is to work to ensure the highest academic achievement and personal development of all of our Silverheights students. Please complete google form: Agenda Item Request for School Council	(A. Jones)
12	Adjournment	

Notes:

MOE – Ontario Ministry of Education

PIC – Parent Involvement Committee (https://www.wrdsb.ca/pic/)

PRO – Parents Reaching Out

SCIS – Safe, Caring & Inclusive Schools (https://www.wrdsb.ca/pic/links/safe-caring-and-inclusive-schools-scis-resources/)

WRAPSC – Waterloo Region Assembly of Public School Councils (https://www.wrdsb.ca/our-schools/get-involved/wrapsc/)

General Council Email: silverheightscouncil@gmail.com

Treasurer's Report – October 2025

Prepared By: Shaun McCracken

Current Approved Budget Status:

The following outlines our current planned/estimated revenue, planned expenditures

Silverheights Public School - Parent Council				
Financial Report Oct 22, 2025				
	Debit	**Credit**	**Total**	**Notes**
Income 2025/26				
Pizza Sales- School day*		$ 67,500.00		*95% of Projected Forecast for Revenue
Domino's fund code*		$ 500.00		*Estimate based on 2024/25 School Year
Total Income:			***$ 68,000.00***	
Approved Expenditures				
Domino's Pizza	-$ 35,000.00			*Estimated Cost for Pizza Days
School Day Fees	-$ 1,350.00			Approved in October 2025 Meeting
Total Approved Expenditures:			**-$ 36,350.00**	
Approved/Allocated Expenditures				
Field Trip Fund	-$ 6,000.00			Approved in October 2025 Meeting
Grade 8 Celebration	-$ 5,000.00			Approved in October 2025 Meeting
Breaking Barriers Fund (Admin Use) Field Trips, Spirit Wear, Athletic Wear	-$ 1,000.00			Approved in October 2025 Meeting
ASD Caregiver Support Event	-$ 500.00			Approved in October 2025 Meeting
Self-Regulation Tools	-$ 1,000.00			Approved in October 2025 Meeting
Floor Mops & Boot Scrubbers	-$ 985.00			Approved in October 2025 Meeting
Spirit Committee - Kindness Month	-$ 300.00			Approved in October 2025 Meeting
Total Approved Expenditures:			**-$ 14,785.00**	
Pending/Future Meeting Requests				
Teacher Education Account (E-Way)	-$ 4,000.00			Deferred to November 2025 Meeting
Drama (Grd 5&6) - Wireless Microphones	-$ 250.00			Deferred to November 2025 Meeting
Total Projected Available Funds:			**$ 16,865.00**	*Projected estimate*